

GRAMMAR: The Present Perfect Tense

The present perfect tense is used to talk about experiences, changes, and actions that happened at an unspecified time in the past and are relevant to the present.

Structure:

Subject + have/has + past participle

Positive form:

I have visited Paris.

She has finished her homework.

Negative form:

I have not (have not) seen that movie.

He has not (has not) called yet.

Question form:

Have you ever tried sushi?

Has she applied for the job?

Key Time Expressions:

ever, never, already, yet, just, since, for, recently, lately

VOCABULARY: Environmental Issues

1. pollution - the presence of harmful substances in the environment

Example: Air pollution is a major problem in many cities.

2. biodiversity - the variety of plant and animal life in a particular habitat

Example: Protecting biodiversity is essential for a healthy ecosystem.

3. renewable energy - energy from sources that are not depleted when used

Collocations: renewable energy sources, renewable energy sector

4. deforestation - the clearing of forests on a massive scale

Synonym: forest clearance, forest destruction

5. carbon footprint - the amount of carbon dioxide released by an activity

Tip: You can reduce your carbon footprint by using public transport.

PRACTICE EXERCISE: Fill in the Blanks

Complete the sentences using the present perfect tense.

1. I _____ (never, see) a shooting star.

Answer: I have never seen a shooting star.

2. She _____ (just, finish) reading that novel.

Answer: She has just finished reading that novel.

3. They _____ (live) here since 2015.

Answer: They have lived here since 2015.

4. Have you ever _____ (try) Thai food?

Answer: Have you ever tried Thai food?

TIPS AND STRATEGIES: Common Mistakes to Avoid

Tip 1: Do not confuse Present Perfect with Simple Past.

Wrong: I have seen him yesterday.

Correct: I saw him yesterday. (specific time, use simple past)

Correct: I have seen him before. (no specific time, use present perfect)

Tip 2: Since vs For

Use SINCE with a point in time: since 2010, since Monday, since last year.

Use FOR with a duration: for 5 years, for a long time, for three months.

Tip 3: Remember irregular past participles.

go becomes gone (NOT goed)

see becomes seen (NOT seed)

take becomes taken (NOT taked)

Note: The present perfect CANNOT be used with specific past time expressions

such as: yesterday, last year, in 1999, two days ago.